

SIPRA DAS



Running for Diplomacy

DELHI Getting away in the middle of the heat and dust of domestic politics can be difficult for a politician, but non-politician Prime Minister Manmohan Singh has decided to take the plunge because of pressing diplomatic agenda. Even as the slugfest continues on the Indo-US nuclear deal and the country stands on the verge of early elections, Manmohan will don the diplomatic mantle and criss-cross the globe in the coming days. He will visit

Africa, on his first bilateral visit since he took over office, on October 14. His first stop will be the Nigerian capital Abuja, where he will hold a meeting with Nigerian President Umaru Yar'adua on October 15. Besides energy security, Manmohan and Yar'adua will sign an Abuja declaration to expand strategic ties. The prime minister will also raise the security concerns of about 20,000 Indians living in the African country.

RUSH HOUR: Manmohan

He will then head to Johannesburg for the second India, Brazil, and South Africa summit on October 17. Manmohan will hold talks with South African President Thabo Mbeki and Brazilian President Luiz Inacio Lula Da Silva over furthering trade and global issues.

The prime minister's next visit will be to Uganda for CHOGM summit in November to lobby support for Kamalesh Sharma, India's envoy to the UK who is contesting for the post of Commonwealth secretary-general. His victory is crucial for India's diplomatic morale after the Shashi Tharoor debacle last year. He will also stop by in Singapore for the East Asia and the Asean-India summits to promote economic diplomacy and will meet Russian President Vladimir Putin before visiting China. Manmohan is clearly in a hurry to wrap up his diplomatic commitments before domestic politics ties him down.

by Saurabh Shukla

Too Fat to Police

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM This is a typical case of cops not being able to catch robbers simply because they can't run. The number of obese and unhealthy policemen is on the rise within the state police department.

A study by a state police department-run hospital among the 1,038 police constables in the



PANKAJ NANGIA

Obesity in khaki

city has revealed that a majority of the men in khaki suffer from obesity and addiction to liquor. While policewomen outnumber policemen in obesity, it is the opposite in the case of alcoholism. While 58.01 per cent of policemen are obese, the percentage of policewomen on the heavier side is 77.18.

Of the 929 policemen who were examined, 70 per cent had cholesterol related problems, 216 had high blood pressure and 211 were diabetic. Among the 109 policewomen, 85.56 per cent had high cholesterol though only 12 per cent were diabetic.

The reasons which make cops unhealthy, according to the study, are the nature of their work, job-related stress, lack of physical exercises, consumption of liquor and overeating. All this in the line of duty.

by M. G. Radhakrishnan

OBJECT OF DESIRE

Ideal Image

SAMSUNG 70-INCH LCD TV, Rs 24 lakh

This LCD TV uses multiple LED backlight units to intuitively sense signals and adjust the brightness levels to produce a dynamic contrast ratio of 500,000:1. The sound system comprises two built-in hidden sub-woofers that boost more power into lower frequencies of the 2.2 channel stereo. Can be hooked into digital cameras and MP3 players. Its high-definition quality comes at blacker blacks, vivid colours and ultra-sharp images. Entertainment just morphed to a brand new level.

